EXPERIMENT NO. 1

Version Control Operations Using Git

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LO2: Use git effectively for version control, source management and team development

1. Aim

To study and perform basic version control operations using Git, including repository initialization, staging, committing, branching, merging, and pushing code to a remote repository (GitHub).

2. Objectives

- To understand the concept and importance of Version Control Systems (VCS).
- To install and configure Git on a local system.
- To create and manage a local Git repository.
- To perform staging and committing of files.
- To create, switch, and merge branches in Git.
- To connect a local repository to a remote repository on GitHub and push changes.

3. Software Requirements

- Git (latest stable version) installed on the system
- Command Line Interface / Terminal (Git Bash, Command Prompt, or equivalent)
- A GitHub account with internet access
- A text editor (optional, for viewing file contents)

4. Theory

Version Control is the practice of tracking and managing changes to files over time, enabling multiple people to collaborate on a project while maintaining a complete history of modifications. It allows developers to revert to earlier versions, compare changes, and understand who made a particular change and why. Version control systems are broadly classified as centralized or distributed, with Git being the most widely used distributed system today.

Git is a free and open-source distributed version control system created by Linus Torvalds in 2005. Unlike centralized systems, Git gives every developer a complete copy of the project history on their local machine, which allows offline work, faster operations, and greater resilience against data loss. Git tracks changes at the level of the entire project through a series of snapshots rather than file differences alone.

A repository (commonly called a 'repo') is the central structure in Git that stores all project files along with the complete history of changes made to them. A repository can exist locally on a developer's machine or remotely on a hosting platform. It contains a hidden .git directory that holds all metadata, configuration, and object history required for version tracking.

A commit is a snapshot of the project at a specific point in time. Each commit is uniquely identified by a hash and includes information such as the author, timestamp, and a descriptive message explaining the change. Commits form the building blocks of a project's history and allow developers to track the evolution of the codebase step by step.

A branch is an independent line of development within a repository. By default, Git creates a branch named 'master' or 'main'. Branches allow developers to work on new features, experiments, or bug fixes in isolation without affecting the stable codebase. Once the work on a branch is complete and tested, it can be integrated back into the main branch.

Merging is the process of combining changes from one branch into another. When a merge is performed, Git attempts to automatically integrate the changes; if the same lines of code have been modified differently in both branches, a merge conflict occurs, which must be resolved manually.

GitHub is a cloud-based hosting service for Git repositories that provides additional collaboration features such as pull requests, issue tracking, code review, and project management tools. By connecting a local Git repository to a remote repository on GitHub, developers can back up their work, collaborate with others, and maintain a publicly or privately accessible version of their project. Commands such as git remote and git push are used to establish and utilize this connection between local and remote repositories.

5. Commands Used

Command	**Purpose**
`git --version`	Check installed Git version
`mkdir GitExperiment`	Create a new directory for the project
`cd GitExperiment`	Navigate into the directory
`pwd`	Print current working directory
`ls`	List files and folders in current directory
`git config --global user.name "Your Name"`	Set global username for Git commits
`git config --global user.email "your@email.com"`	Set global email for Git commits
`git config --list`	Display all Git configuration settings
`git init`	Initialize a new Git repository
`git status`	Show current state of working directory and staging area

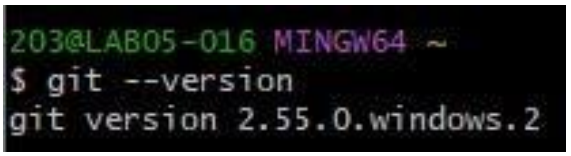
`echo Hello Git > file1.txt`	Create a text file with sample content
`cat file1.txt`	Display contents of a file
`git add file1.txt`	Stage a specific file for commit
`git commit -m "message"`	Record staged changes to repository history
`git log`	View commit history in detail
`git add .`	Stage all modified/new files in the directory
`git log --oneline`	View condensed, one-line-per-commit history
`git branch <name>`	Create a new branch
`git branch`	List all local branches
`git checkout <branch>`	Switch to the specified branch
`git checkout master`	Switch back to the master branch
`git merge <branch>`	Merge specified branch into current branch
`git log --oneline --graph`	View commit history as a graph
`git remote add origin <url>`	Link local repository to a remote GitHub repository
Command	**Purpose**
`git remote -v`	View configured remote repository URLs
`git branch -M main`	Rename current branch to main
`git push -u origin main`	Push local commits to remote repository and set upstream

6. Procedure

Step 1

```
git --version
```

Verifies that Git is installed on the system and displays its version number.



Step 2

```
mkdir GitExperiment
```

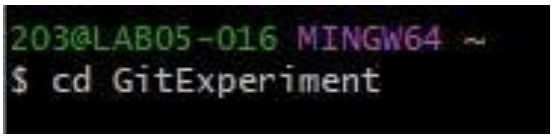
Creates a new folder named GitExperiment to serve as the project directory.



Step 3

```
cd GitExperiment
```

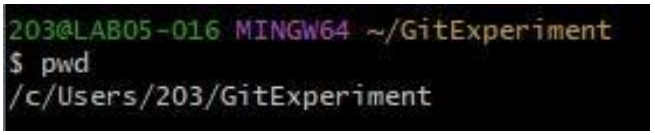
Changes the current directory into the newly created GitExperiment folder.



Step 4

```
pwd
```

Displays the absolute path of the current working directory to confirm location.



Step 5

```
ls
```

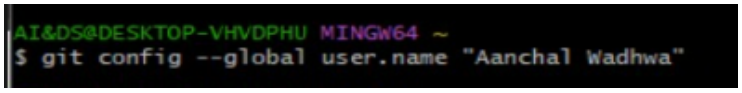
Lists the contents of the current directory (initially empty).



Step 6

```
git config --global user.name "Your Name"
```

Sets the global Git username used to identify the author of commits.



Step 7

```
git config --global user.email "your@email.com"
```

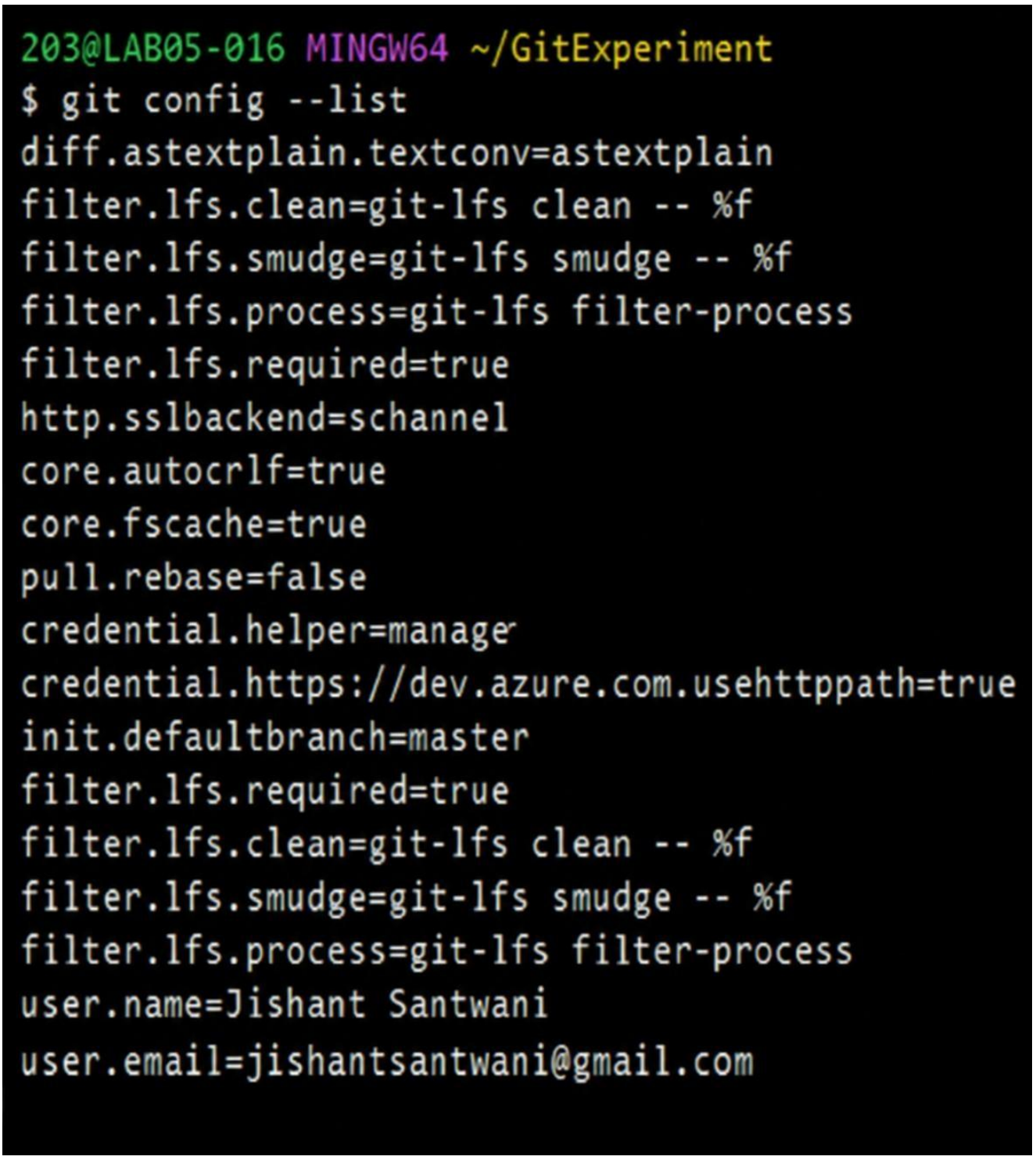
Sets the global Git email associated with commits.



Step 8

```
git config --list
```

Displays the complete list of configured Git settings to verify the username and email.



Step 9

```
git init
```

Initializes an empty Git repository in the current directory, creating a hidden .git folder.

```
203@LAB05-016 MINGW64 ~/GitExperiment
$ git init
Initialized empty Git repository in C:/Users/203/GitExperiment/.git/
```

Step 10

```
git status
```

Displays the current status of the repository, confirming it is empty and clean.

```
203@LAB05-016 MINGW64 ~/GitExperiment (master)
$ git status
On branch master

No commits yet

nothing to commit (create/copy files and use "git add" to track)
```

Step 11

```
echo Hello Git > file1.txt
```

Creates a new file, file1.txt, containing the text "Hello Git".

```
203@LAB05-016 MINGW64 ~/GitExperiment (master)
$ echo Hello Git > file1.txt
```

Step 12

```
cat file1.txt
```

Displays the contents of file1.txt to confirm it was created correctly.

```
203@LAB05-016 MINGW64 ~/GitExperiment (master)
$ ls
file1.txt

203@LAB05-016 MINGW64 ~/GitExperiment (master)
$ cat file1.txt
Hello Git
```

Step 13

```
git add file1.txt
```

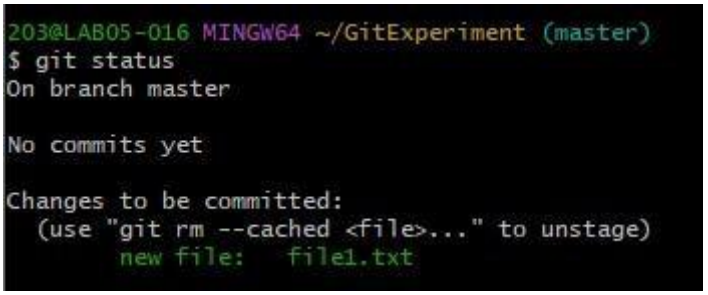
Stages file1.txt, moving it to the staging area in preparation for a commit.

```
203@LAB05-016 MINGW64 ~/GitExperiment (master)
$ git add file1.txt
warning: in the working copy of 'file1.txt', LF will be replaced by CRLF the next time Git touches
it
```

Step 14

```
git status
```

Confirms that file1.txt is now staged and ready to be committed.



Step 15

```
git commit -m "First Commit"
```

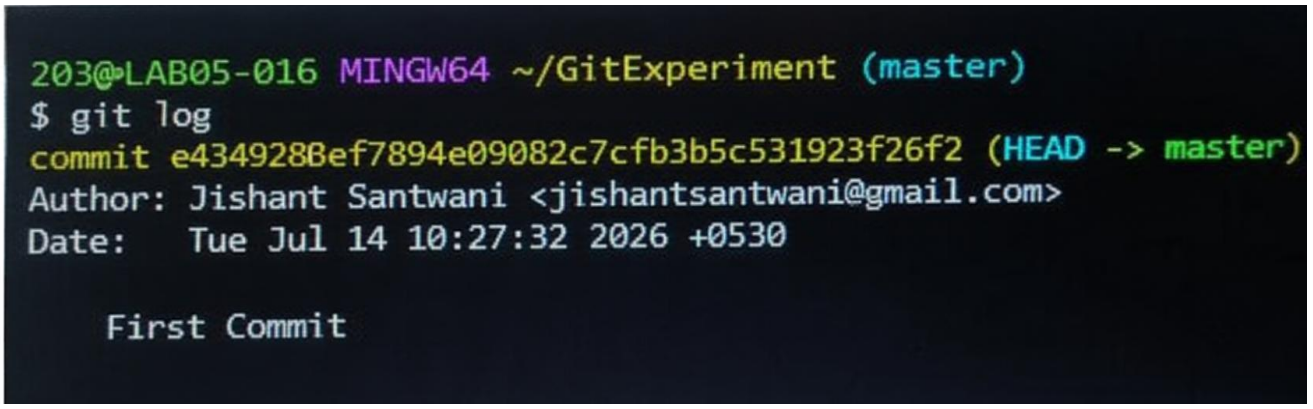
Commits the staged file to the repository with the message "First Commit".



Step 16

```
git log
```

Displays the detailed commit history, showing the commit hash, author, date, and message.



Step 17

```
echo This is second file > file2.txt
```

Creates a second file, file2.txt, with sample content.



Step 18

```
git status
```

Shows that file2.txt is untracked and not yet staged.

```
203@LAB05-016 MINGW64 ~/GitExperiment (master)
$ git status
On branch master
Untracked files:
  (use "git add <file>..." to include in what will be committed)
        file2.txt

nothing added to commit but untracked files present (use "git add" to track)
```

Step 19

```
git add .
```

Stages all changes in the working directory, including the new file2.txt.

```
203@LAB05-016 MINGW64 ~/GitExperiment (master)
$ git add .
warning: in the working copy of 'file2.txt', LF will be replaced by CRLF the next time Git touches
i
t
```

Step 20

```
git status
```

Confirms that file2.txt is now staged for commit.

```
203@LAB05-016 MINGW64 ~/GitExperiment (master)
$ git status
On branch master
Changes to be committed:
  (use "git restore --staged <file>..." to unstage)
        new file:   file2.txt
```

Step 21

```
git commit -m "Added second file"
```

Commits the staged changes with the message "Added second file".

```
203@LAB05-016 MINGW64 ~/GitExperiment (master)
$ git commit -m "Added second file"
[master aadd67f] Added second file
 1 file changed, 1 insertion(+)
 create mode 100644 file2.txt
```

Step 22

```
git log --oneline
```

Displays a condensed commit history showing both commits made so far.

```
203@LAB05-016 MINGW64 ~/GitExperiment (master)
$ git log --oneline
aadd67f (HEAD -> master) Added second file
e434928 First Commit
```

Step 23

```
git branch newbranch
```

Creates a new branch named newbranch from the current commit.

```
203@LAB05-016 MINGW64 ~/GitExperiment (master)
$ git branch newbranch
```

Step 24

`git branch`

Lists all branches in the repository and highlights the currently active branch.

```
203@LAB05-016 MINGW64 ~/GitExperiment (master)
$ git branch
* master
  newbranch
```

Step 25

`git checkout newbranch`

Switch the working directory to newbranch.

```
203@LAB05-016 MINGW64 ~/GitExperiment (master)
$ git checkout newbranch
Switched to branch 'newbranch'
```

Step 26

`echo Branch File > branch.txt`

Creates a new file, branch.txt, specific to the new branch.

```
203@LAB05-016 MINGW64 ~/GitExperiment (newbranch)
$ echo Branch File > branch.txt
```

Step 27

`git add .`

Stages the newly created branch.txt file.

```
203@LAB05-016 MINGW64 ~/GitExperiment (newbranch)
$ git add .
warning: in the working copy of 'branch.txt', LF will be replaced by CRLF the next time Git touches
 it
```

Step 28

`git commit -m "Added branch file"`

Commits branch.txt on newbranch with an appropriate message.

```
203@LAB05-016 MINGW64 ~/GitExperiment (newbranch)
$ git commit -m "Added branch file"
[newbranch ade6aa8] Added branch file
 1 file changed, 1 insertion(+)
 create mode 100644 branch.txt
```

Step 29

`git checkout master`

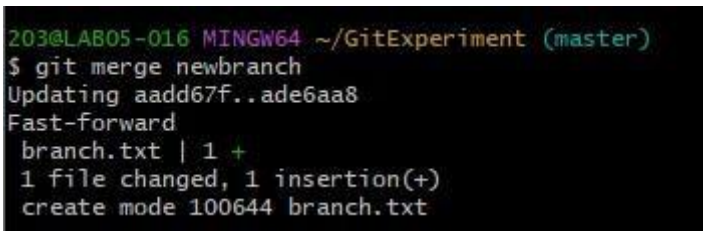
Switches back to the master branch.

```
203@LAB05-016 MINGW64 ~/GitExperiment (newbranch)
$ git checkout master
Switched to branch 'master'
```

Step 30

```
git merge newbranch
```

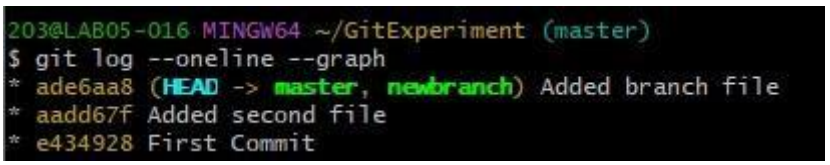
Merges the changes from newbranch into the master branch.



Step 31

```
git log --oneline --graph
```

Displays the commit history as a graph, showing the branch and merge structure.



Step 32

```
git remote add origin https://github.com/ascendant-creator/GitExperiment.git
```

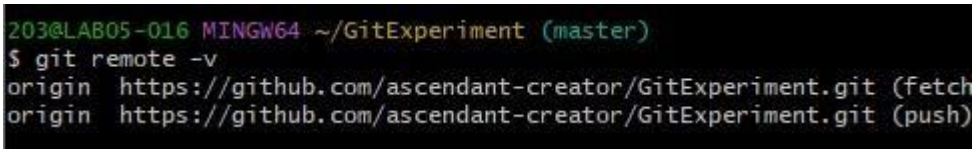
Links the local repository to a remote repository hosted on GitHub, named origin.



Step 33

```
git remote -v
```

Verifies the configured remote repository URLs for fetch and push operations.



Step 34

```
git branch -M main
```

Renames the current branch from master to main, following GitHub's default naming convention.



7. Observation

On executing the above commands, Git successfully tracked all changes made within the GitExperiment directory. The git status command correctly reflected the state of files as untracked, staged, or committed at each stage. The git log and git log --oneline commands displayed an accurate, chronological history of all commits. A new branch (newbranch) was successfully created and merged into the master branch without conflicts, since the changes involved different, non-overlapping files. The repository was successfully linked to

a remote GitHub repository, and the branch was renamed to main to match GitHub's default convention prior to pushing.

8. Result

The version control operations using Git including repository initialization, staging, committing, branching, merging, and pushing to a remote GitHub repository were performed successfully, and the expected outcomes were observed at each stage.

9. Conclusion

Through this experiment, the fundamental concepts and operations of Git as a distributed version control system were studied and practically implemented. The exercise provided hands-on experience in initializing repositories, tracking file changes, creating commits, managing branches, merging code, and synchronizing a local repository with a remote GitHub repository. This forms the foundation for collaborative software development practices used extensively in the industry.